

CLAT GK - Test 08 - Answer Key

Date: 2026-10-08

Note: Generated with Haiku 5.5, then independently verified question by question by separate Sonnet agents using fresh searches (two-source rule; claims that could not be confirmed were removed or reworded; ambiguous, unchecked or overlapping questions were dropped). Several primary sources were unreachable, so residual risk is listed below. Not reviewed by a human.

Facts resting on a single or secondary source (residual risk):

- Passage 1: Q1,Q2,Q4,Q5,Q6,Q7 static articles confirmed from constitution-text sites plus exam-prep/explainer snippets; no judgment or gazette fetched (WebFetch unreachable).
- Passage 1: Passage claims rest on search summaries of IANS, FPJ, Deccan Chronicle, Hitavada, Daily Pioneer, Madhyamam; pages could not be fetched directly.
- Passage 1: Live-in one-month registration and equal-inheritance wording: several outlets agree, exact clause not seen in Bill text.
- Passage 1: Assent authority (President vs Governor) conflicts across reports (LiveLaw, AIR: Governor); claim reworded to generic 'requires assent'.
- Passage 1: Passage is short (about 180 words) after culling unconfirmed claims.
- Passage 2: Cabinet decision (Kerala, Sep 2026) and map by environment department: Onmanorama prominent; ThePrint snippet only, content not read.
- Passage 2: 2026 state-wise areas (Goa, TN, Maharashtra) and Kerala 131 villages: 2026 Wire/Drishti-type reports plus identical 2024 sixth-draft figures; no official gazette read.
- Passage 2: Hydel regulated / agriculture and plantations unaffected: only exam-prep explainers (Drishti, Vajiram etc.), no primary or news confirmation.
- Passage 2: Sanjay Kumar leading 2022 expert committee (Q6 explanation only): Deccan Herald 2022 and exam-prep/news sites; extension to July 2027 from Superkalam/EaseMyPrep.
- Passage 2: Eco-sensitive zone legal basis (Q1): explainer sites (ClearIAS, Casemine, officerspulse) plus India Environment Portal; no gazette read.
- Passage 2: Passage is short (about 200 words), SHORT.
- Passage 3: Q5 (Art 226 'any other purpose') rests on exam-prep/legal-blog pages and a secondhand Common Cause quote; official text not reached.
- Passage 3: Q7 statements 3 and 4 (Art 124(7), 124(1)): Lok Sabha answer plus Common Cause/LiveLaw and journalsofindia/Drishti; constitutional text itself not fetched (WebFetch unavailable).
- Passage 3: Q3 match: Art 148, 217, 280, 311 confirmed via mostly exam-prep and legal-blog pages; official text not fetched.
- Passage 3: Passage line on Centre/states told to comply at once with warning of serious action: seen only in search summaries of Careers360, Onmanorama/TNM-type reports, not read in full.
- Passage 3: Passage ~170 words after adding two confirmed details (book title, show-cause purpose); still under the usual length but confirmed facts only. Fetching failed on all hosts, so checks used search snippets.
- Passage 3: Case later closed on 1 Sept 2026 after the chapter was replaced; passage reports only Feb 2026 events.
- Passage 4: Passage is very short (~126 words), SHORT; no padding added.
- Passage 4: Q1 (DAC chair): confirmed by PTI report on this meeting plus exam-prep explainer iasgyan; MoD PDF not fetched.
- Passage 4: AoN as first formal step (Q4 reason): IDSA plus exam-prep sites; MoD Aon_1.pdf not opened.
- Passage 4: Q5 stnt II (Lyulka to NPO Saturn lineage): Wikipedia and GlobalSecurity snippet only; GlobalSecurity page unreachable by fetch.
- Passage 4: Q7 Su-30MKI-HAL: licence production via Janes/PIB; 'designed by Sukhoi' only Wikipedia plus copies (not asked in kept Qs).
- Passage 4: Q7 S-400 Almaz-Antey and Akash DRDO from search summaries (Wikipedia, TASS, warhistory, airforce-technology); fetches failed.

- Passage 4: Q7 list item 'Ordnance Factory Board' is historic: OFB was corporatised in 2021 (successor AWEIL); Dhanush developed under OFB.
- Passage 4: Q3 45-calibre: search summaries of GlobalSecurity, Janes, aviation-defence-universe; full text not fetched.
- Passage 5: Passage is very short (about 120 words) after cuts; SHORT.
- Passage 5: Q6 (G7 no charter/secretariat/consensus) rests on Senate paper, G7 database, Guttry paper and Model Diplomat; no official G7 statement found.
- Passage 5: Q3 DRC cobalt share: USGS table not retrieved; DRC largest rests on Cobalt Institute, Mining Technology and Measured World aggregator.
- Passage 5: Q7 lithium ranking: USGS table not retrieved; figures via K&L Gates, Measured World (EIA-style) and a Chilean news report citing USGS.
- Passage 5: Q4 assertion Ministry of Mines administers NCMM: PIB text mirror plus news; no separate ministry page retrieved.
- Passage 5: Evian dates 15-17 June confirmed (Elysee/G7 Research Group); passage kept as mid-June.
- Static-GK explanations cite Wikipedia or exam-prep pages in places where a primary text was not reachable.

1. B	2. B	3. C	4. B	5. B	6. D
7. D	8. A	9. D	10. B	11. B	12. A
13. C	14. A	15. D	16. D	17. A	18. D
19. A	20. A	21. D	22. A	23. C	24. C
25. B	26. B	27. D	28. C	29. D	30. D

Passage 1: Madhya Pradesh UCC Bill 2026

Q1. Answer: (B) Concurrent List

Explanation: Marriage and divorce is an entry in the Concurrent List (List III) of the Seventh Schedule, which is why both Parliament and State legislatures can make laws on it. Union List and State List subjects are exclusive to the Centre and the states respectively, so neither fits.

Source: <https://livelaw.in/know-the-law/concept-of-repugnancy-under-article-254-173619> ;
<https://www.legacyias.com/article-44-uniform-civil-code/>

Q2. Answer: (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Explanation: Article 15 prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth (D). Article 16 guarantees equality of opportunity in public employment (A). Article 17 abolishes untouchability (C). Article 32 gives the right to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights (B).

Source: <https://www.pmfias.com/articles-14-17-provisions-matching-upsc-prelims-pyq-2004/> ;
<https://blog.ipleaders.in/significance-of-article-32-of-the-constitution-of-india-right-to-constitutional-remedies/> ; <https://en.vikaspedia.in/viewcontent/education/law-and-constitution/fundamental-rights-article-14-35/articles-14-18-of-the-indian-constitution-equality-and-its-implications?lg=en>

Q3. Answer: (C) Both I and II

Explanation: Both statements are correct. Article 200 gives the Governor four options on a State Bill, one of which is reserving it for the President. Article 213 allows the Governor to promulgate ordinances during the recess of the Legislature, subject to conditions.

Source: <https://www.gktoday.in/powers-of-the-governor-with-special-reference-to-article-200/> ;
https://www.constitutionofindia.net/constitution_of_india/the_states/articles/Article%20213 ;
<https://www.casemine.com/in/column/article-213-of-the-indian-constitution:-the-governor-s-ordinance-making-power/view>

Q4. Answer: (B) Article 44

Explanation: Article 44 is the Directive Principle that asks the State to endeavour to secure a uniform civil code for citizens. Article 37 says Directive Principles are not enforceable by courts, Article 51A lists Fundamental Duties, and Article 370 concerned Jammu and Kashmir.

Source: <https://www.legacyias.com/article-44-uniform-civil-code/> ; <https://www.anantamias.com/uniform-civil-code-uttarakhand/>

Q5. Answer: (B) I and II only

Explanation: Statements I and II correctly describe Articles 25 and 26. Statement III attributes to Article 27 a rule that belongs to Article 28; Article 27 bars taxes whose proceeds are specifically appropriated to promote a particular religion. So only I and II are correct.

Source: <https://lawfoyer.in/right-to-freedom-of-religion-articles-25-28/> ; https://studyhub.net.in/indian_constitution/right-to-freedom-of-religion/

Q6. Answer: (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Explanation: A is false because the Uniform Civil Code is a Directive Principle in Part IV, which courts cannot enforce, not a Fundamental Right in Part III. R is true: Article 14 applies to every person, including non-citizens. A false, R true gives option 3.

Source: <https://www.latestlaws.com/bare-acts/central-acts-rules/coi-article-14-equality-before-law/> ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Article_14_of_the_Constitution_of_India ; <https://www.legacyias.com/article-44-uniform-civil-code/>

Passage sources:

<https://ianslive.in/mp-assembly-passes-uniform-civil-code-bill-amid-opposition-protests-uproar--20260721154425>

<https://www.freepressjournal.in/amp/bhopal/mp-assembly-passes-historic-ucc-bill-2026-amid-protests-and-stormy-debates>

<https://www.deccanchronicle.com/nation/mp-assembly-passes-ucc-bill-2026-amid-noisy-protest-by-congress-1972779>

<https://www.thehitavada.com//Encyc/2026/7/22/mp-assembly-passes-ucc-bill-chief-minister-hails-passing-of-the-bill-as-golden-day.html>

<https://www.latestly.com/india/news/uniform-civil-code-bill-2026-passed-in-madhya-pradesh-fourth-state-to-adopt-ucc-7525817.html/amp>

<https://dce.visionias.in/news-today/2026-07-22/polity-and-governance/madhya-pradesh-assembly-passes-uniform-civil-code-ucc-bill-2026>

<https://www.deccanchronicle.com/nation/madhya-pradesh-ucc-bill-2026-tabled-in-mp-assembly-1972522>

<https://www.deccanchronicle.com/nation/mp-govt-pushes-ucc-bill-amid-congress-storm-over-cm-land-purchase-allegations-1972500>

<https://theprint.in/india/mp-govt-tables-ucc-bill-in-assembly-amid-cong-uproar-over-cm-land-purchase-allegations/2991136/>

<https://newsonair.gov.in/madhya-pradesh-assembly-introduces-uniform-civil-code-bill-2026/>

<https://thefederal.com/category/states/north/madhya-pradesh/mp-assembly-passes-uniform-civil-code-bill-amid-congress-protest-250896>

Passage 2: Defence Acquisition Council approvals, March 2026

Q7. Answer: (D) 45

Explanation: The Dhanush is a 155 mm/45 calibre gun, with a barrel lengthened from the 39-calibre barrel of the original Bofors FH-77B.

Source: <https://www.globalsecurity.org/military/world/india/danush.htm> ; <https://www.aviation-defence-universe.com/indian-army-gets-dhanush-artillery-guns-in-its-inventory> ; <https://www.janes.com/defence-intelligence-insights/defence-news/indian-army-receives-first-six-of-114-dhanush-howitzers>

Q8. Answer: (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Explanation: Dhanush is produced by the Ordnance Factory Board; the Su-30MKI is built under licence by HAL; the S-400 is developed by Russia's Almaz-Antey; the Akash was developed by DRDO.

Source: <https://www.globalsecurity.org/military/world/india/danush.htm> ; <https://www.janes.com/osint-insights/defence-news/hal-completes-licensed-production-of-final-two-of-222-su-30mki-fighters-for-iaf> ; <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2083948> ; <https://www.airforce-technology.com/projects/akash-surface-to-air-missile-system/> ; <https://tass.com/defense/1222467/amp> ; <https://warhistory.org/%40msw/article/almaz-antey-40r6-s-400-triumf>

Q9. Answer: (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Explanation: The assertion is false: AoN is an in-principle approval of necessity, not a payment or contract sanction. The reason is true: AoN is the first formal step, followed by tendering and contracting.

Source: <https://idsa.in/publisher/comments/nurturing-capital-acquisitions> ; <https://anantamias.com/current-affairs/dac-aon-defence-acquisition-indigenisation/?pdf=1> ; https://www.mod.gov.in/dod/sites/default/files/Aon_1.pdf

Q10. Answer: (B) II only

Explanation: Statement I is false: the AL-31 family was designed by Lyulka/NPO Saturn in the Soviet Union and Russia, and HAL builds it under licence in India. Statement II is true. Only II is correct.

Source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Saturn_AL-31 ; <https://www.globalsecurity.org/military/world/russia/lyulka.htm> ;
<https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2053088®=3&lang=2> ;
<https://www.janes.com/osint-insights/defence-news/defence/indian-mod-awards-contract-to-produce-new-su-30mki-engines>

Q11. Answer: (B) Raksha Mantri

Explanation: The DAC is chaired by the Raksha Mantri (Defence Minister). The Chief of Defence Staff, the Defence Secretary and the service chiefs are members, not the chair.

Source: <https://www.theweek.in/wire-updates/national/2026/03/27/dac-clears-massive-rs-2.38-lakh-cr-military-procurement-including-s-400s-60-transport-aircraft.html> ; <https://www.iasgyan.in/daily-current-affairs/defence-acquisition-council>

Q12. Answer: (A) Only one

Explanation: Only statement 2 is correct. The S-400 is a long-range, mobile system; the Dhanush is a towed gun; the Akash is a medium-range surface-to-air missile, not a ballistic missile.

Source: <https://www.india.com/news/india/army-inducts-indigenously-built-surface-to-air-missile-akash-373609/> ;
<https://www.indiandefencereview.com/indigenously-designed-surface-to-air-akash-missile-inducted-into-the-iaf/> ;
<https://www.globalsecurity.org/military/world/india/danush.htm> ; <https://alphadefense.in/encyclopedia/s-400-triumf-india-sudarshan-chakra/>

Passage sources:

<https://raksha-anirveda.com/boosting-defence-capability-dac-clears-proposals-worth-rs-2-38-lakh-crore>
<https://deccanchronicle.com/southern-states/telangana/rs-238-lakh-cr-defence-deals-approved-1946769>
<https://morungexpress.com/centre-gives-nod-for-buying-military-hardware-worth-rs-238-lakh-crore>
<https://www.lifeofsoldiers.com/2026/03/28/dac-clears-proposals-worth-rs-2-38-lakh-crore-to-augment-defence-capabilities/>
<https://www.globalsecurity.org/wmd/library/news/india/2026/india-260327-india-pib01.htm>
<https://www.aviation-defence-universe.com/dac-clears-proposals-worth-rs-2-38-lakh-crore-to-augment-defence-capabilities/>

Passage 3: NCERT Textbook and the Supreme Court

Q13. Answer: (C) Article 136

Explanation: Article 136 gives the Supreme Court discretion to grant special leave to appeal, except from armed forces tribunals. Article 134 deals with appeals in certain criminal cases.

Source: <https://bhattandjoshiassociates.com/special-leave-petition-to-the-supreme-court-after-a-gujarat-high-court-order/> ;
<https://ssrana.in/litigation/special-leave-petition-india/>

Q14. Answer: (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Explanation: Article 148 provides for the CAG, appointed by the President and removable on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge. Article 217 covers appointment of High Court judges. Article 280 provides for the Finance Commission. Article 311 protects civil servants from dismissal by a subordinate authority.

Source: <https://www.constitutionofindia.net/articles/article-148-comptroller-and-auditor-general-of-india> ;
<https://cag.gov.in/page-constitutional-provisions> ;
<https://www.constitutionofindia.net/articles/article-217-appointment-and-conditions-of-the-office-of-a-> ;
<https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/article-217-of-the-indian-constitution/> ;
<https://www.drishti judiciary.com/to-the-point/tp-constitution-of-india/article-280-of-the-coi> ;
<https://blog.ipleaders.in/article-280-of-the-indian-constitution/> ; <https://blog.ipleaders.in/article-311-of-the-indian-constitution/> ;
<https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/?p=25565>

Q15. Answer: (D) All four

Explanation: All four statements are correct. Article 124(2) sets retirement at 65, Article 124(4) sets removal on proved misbehaviour or incapacity by a special majority, Article 124(7) bars post-retirement practice, and Article 124(1) lets Parliament fix the number of other judges by law.

Source: <https://drishtias.com/pdf/1719770781.pdf> ; <https://www.pw.live/judiciary/exams/how-supreme-court-judges-are-appointed-in-india> ;
<https://www.understandupsc.com/article-1241/> ; <https://laex.in/prelims-fact-sheet/supreme-court-composition-strength/>

Q16. Answer: (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Explanation: The assertion is false because Article 226 extends High Court writ jurisdiction to any other purpose, beyond Fundamental Rights. The reason is true.

Source: <https://anantamias.com/article-226-indian-constitution/?pdf=1> ; <https://bhattandjoshiassociates.com/understanding-writ-jurisdiction-under-article-226-a-comprehensive-guide-to-constitutional-remedies-before-the-gujarat-high-court/>

Q17. Answer: (A) Article 129

Explanation: Article 129 declares the Supreme Court a court of record and gives it the power to punish for contempt of itself. Article 215 gives the same status to High Courts.

Source: <https://www.constitutionofindia.net/articles/article-129-supreme-court-to-be-a-court-of-record/> ;
<https://www.understandupsc.com/article-129-of-indian-constitution/> ; <https://main.sci.gov.in/jonew/judis/13280.pdf>

Q18. Answer: (D) Neither I nor II

Explanation: Neither is correct. Article 21A covers children aged six to fourteen, and Article 76 provides that the President appoints the Attorney General for India.

Source: <https://blog.ipleaders.in/article-21a-of-indian-constitution/> ; <https://vidhijudicial.com/article-21a-of-the-constitution-of-india.html> ;
<https://www.constitutionofindia.net/articles/article-76-attorney-general-for-india/> ;
<https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/article-76-of-indian-constitution/>

Passage sources:

<https://www.newsonair.gov.in/supreme-court-takes-cognisance-of-references-to-corruption-in-judiciary-in-class-8-ncert-textbook>

<https://kashmirreader.com/2026/02/25/sc-takes-cognisance-of-ncert-class-8-chapter-on-corruption-in-judiciary/>

<https://news.careers360.com/supreme-court-bans-class-8-social-science-textbook-judiciary-corruption-chapter-4-copies-seizure-digital-taked-own-ncert-director/amp>

<https://www.onmanorama.com/news/india/2026/02/26/supreme-court-india-ncert-textbook-ban.amp.html>

<https://morungexpress.com/sc-orders-seizure-bans-ncert-book-over-corruption-in-judiciary-chapter>

<https://thewire.in/law/supreme-court-bans-ncert-book-with-judicial-corruption-chapter-issues-notice-to-school-education-secretary>

<https://www.verdictum.in/court-updates/supreme-court/deep-rooted-conspiracy-ncert-published-class-8-book-corruption-in-judiciary-1608740>

Passage 4: G7 Evian summit and critical minerals

Q19. Answer: (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Explanation: Germany held the G7 presidency in 2022 (Elmau, June 2022); Japan in 2023 (Hiroshima, May 2023); Italy in 2024 (Borgo Egnazia, Apulia, June 2024); Canada in 2025 (Kananaskis, June 2025).

Source: <https://www.bundesregierung.de/breg-en/news/g7-start-1994300> ;
<https://www.developmentaid.org/news-stream/post/145147/g7-summit-2022> ; <https://www.arabnews.com/node/2112576> ;
https://www.mofa.go.jp/policy/other/bluebook/2023/en_html/chapter3/c030303.html ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/50th_G7_summit ;
<https://www.governo.it/en/node/25984> ; <https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/canada-g7-presidency-2025-1.7421639> ;
<https://cfjctoday.com/2025/01/02/canada-set-to-preside-over-g7-in-2025-what-that-means-and-whats-at-stake/> ;
<https://g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2025kananaskis/index.html> ; <https://www.bundesregierung.de/breg-en/service/g7-at-schloss-elmau-1991596>

Q20. Answer: (A) I and III only

Explanation: Australia (about 92,000 t lithium content) led 2025 mine output in the USGS table, followed by China (about 62,000 t) and Chile (about 56,000 t). So I and III are correct and II is incorrect.

Source: <https://pubs.usgs.gov/periodicals/mcs2026/mcs2026-lithium.pdf> ;
<https://www.klgates.com/thought-leadership/USGS-Discovers-23-Million-Ton-Appalachian-Lithium-Deposit-7-22-2026> ;
<https://measuredworld.com/categories/resources/lithium-production> ;
<https://www.meganoticias.cl/nacional/515760-china-desplaza-a-chile-al-tercer-lugar-en-produccion-mundial-de-litio-usgs-27-2-2026.html>

Q21. Answer: (D) Democratic Republic of the Congo

Explanation: The Democratic Republic of the Congo produced roughly 72-75% of world cobalt in 2025 estimates, far ahead of Indonesia (about 14%). Zambia and Peru are much smaller producers.

Source: <https://www.cobaltinstitute.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/Biannual-Cobalt-Market-report-H1-2026.pdf> ;
<https://www.mining-technology.com/analyst-comment/drc-indonesia-anchor-global-cobalt-supply/> ;
<https://measuredworld.com/categories/resources/cobalt-production>

Q22. Answer: (A) 2014

Explanation: At an emergency meeting in March 2014 (The Hague), G7 leaders suspended their participation in the G8 until Russia changed course, after Russia annexed Crimea. The G8 summit planned for Sochi was moved to Brussels.

Source: <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2014/3/24/g7-nations-suspend-russia-and-scrap-g8-summit> ;
<https://www.nbcnews.com/news/amp/ncna42701> ; <https://www.rferl.org/a/russia-g8-status-perspectives/25309385.html>

Q23. Answer: (C) (A) is true but (R) is false

Explanation: A is true: the mission is run by the Ministry of Mines. R is false: the Union Cabinet approved the mission in January 2025 (29 January 2025), not in 2021.

Source: https://www.pmindia.gov.in/en/news_updates/cabinet-approves-national-critical-mineral-mission-to-build-a-resilient-value-chain-for-critical-mineral-resources-vital-to-green-technologies-with-an-outlay-of-rs-34300-crore-over-seven-years ;
<https://www.narendramodi.in/cabinet-approves-national-critical-mineral-mission> ;
<https://www.outlookindia.com/national/union-cabinet-approves-national-critical-mineral-mission-with-outlay-of-rs-34-cr-over-7-years> ;
<https://www.energetica-india.net/news/union-cabinet-approves-launch-of-inr-16300-crore-national-critical-mineral-mission>

Q24. Answer: (C) Only three

Explanation: Statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct: the G7 has no charter, offices or permanent administration, and decides by consensus without formal votes. Statement 4 is incorrect because G7 commitments are political rather than legally binding. Three statements are correct, so the answer is 'Only three'.

Source: https://www.sencanada.ca/media/365559/senboehm_article_2019-06-28_e.pdf ;
<https://g7g20-documents.org/about-the-database/about-g7> ; <https://g7.utoronto.ca/scholar/guttry1994/guttry.htm> ;
<https://modeldiplomat.com/learn/glossary/g7-leaders-summit>

Passage sources:

<https://www.elysee.fr/en/G7evian/2026/06/17/g7-leaders-declaration-on-securing-supply-chains-for-critical-minerals>

<https://www.mofa.go.jp/mofaj/files/101046856.pdf>

<https://g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2026evian/critical-minerals-annex.html>

<https://www.tribuneindia.com/news/vulnerabilities/g7-unveils-declaration-to-strengthen-resilience-of-critical-minerals-supply-chains>

<https://www.mining-technology.com/news/g7-rare-earth-targets-could-spur-investment-in-non-chinese-supply-chains/>

<https://www.euronews.com/my-europe/2026/06/17/six-takeaways-from-the-g7-summit-in-evian>

<https://www.dtnext.in/news/world/g7-leaders-open-summit-talks-on-ukraine-and-the-middle-east-as-zelenskyy-joins-in-france>

<https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2014/3/24/g7-nations-suspend-russia-and-scrap-g8-summit>

<https://www.nbcnews.com/news/amp/ncna42701>

<https://www.rferl.org/a/russia-g8-status-perspectives/25309385.html>

<https://www.cobaltinstitute.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/Biannual-Cobalt-Market-report-H1-2026.pdf>

<https://www.mining-technology.com/analyst-comment/drc-indonesia-anchor-global-cobalt-supply/>

<https://measuredworld.com/categories/resources/cobalt-production>

<https://www.bundesregierung.de/breg-en/news/g7-start-1994300>

<https://www.developmentaid.org/news-stream/post/145147/g7-summit-2022>

<https://www.arabnews.com/node/2112576>

https://www.mofa.go.jp/policy/other/bluebook/2023/en_html/chapter3/c030303.html

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/50th_G7_summit

<https://www.governo.it/en/node/25984>

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Passage 5: Western Ghats eco-sensitive draft and Kerala's exclusion plea

Q25. Answer: (B) II only

Explanation: Only II is correct. The WGEEP was headed by Madhav Gadgil. Sanjay Kumar leads the later expert committee formed in 2022, which is separate from the WGEEP.

Source: <https://www.clearias.com/gadgil-report-kasturirangan-report-western-ghats/> ;
<https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/western-ghats-controversy/>

Q26. Answer: (B) 2012

Explanation: The Western Ghats received UNESCO World Heritage status in 2012, at the 36th session of the World Heritage Committee in St Petersburg.

Source: <https://www.downtoearth.org.in/amp/story/environment/western-ghats-get-world-heritage-site-tag-38604> ; <https://www.hinduismtoday.com/hpi/2012/07/06/india-s-western-ghats-given-unesco-world-heritage-status-httpwwwbbccouknewsworld-asia-india-18669534/>

Q27. Answer: (D) Environment (Protection) Act, 1986

Explanation: Eco-sensitive zones are notified under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, with factors such as biodiversity, proximity to sanctuaries and national parks, and wildlife corridors considered. The other three Acts do not provide the notification basis for these zones.

Source: <https://indiaenvironmentportal.org.in/reports-and-documents/question-raised-in-rajya-sabha-on-eco-sensitive-areas-25042016> ;
<https://www.gktoday.in/gk/eco-sensitive-zones/>

Q28. Answer: (C) Only three

Explanation: Statements 1, 2 and 3 are correct. Statement 4 is wrong: Maharashtra's share is 17,340 sq km. Three statements are correct, so the answer is Only three.

Source: <https://keralakaumudi.com/en/news/news-amp.php?id=1357694> ;
<https://www.onmanorama.com/news/kerala/2026/09/25/kerala-wants-residential-agricultural-areas-excluded-from-western-ghats-esa.html> ;
<https://m.thewire.in/article/environment/union-govt-reissues-notification-proposing-56800-sq-km-as-eco-sensitive-areas-in-western-ghats>

Q29. Answer: (D) Karnataka

Explanation: Karnataka has the largest share of the draft at 20,668 sq km, out of a total of 56,825.7 sq km across six states.

Source: <https://m.thewire.in/article/environment/union-govt-reissues-notification-proposing-56800-sq-km-as-eco-sensitive-areas-in-western-ghats> ;
<https://keralakaumudi.com/en/news/news-amp.php?id=1357694>

Q30. Answer: (D) (A) is false but (R) is true

Explanation: A is false: the Gadgil (WGEEP) report was submitted in August 2011, and the Kasturirangan report came later, in April 2013. R is true: the Gadgil report was submitted in 2011.

Source: <https://www.clearias.com/gadgil-report-kasturirangan-report-western-ghats/> ;
<https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/gadgil-report-on-western-ghats-why-the-gadgil-report-still-shapes-environmental-debate/>

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<https://www.onmanorama.com/news/kerala/2026/09/25/kerala-wants-residential-agricultural-areas-excluded-from-western-ghats-esa.html>

<https://theprint.in/india/keralam-moves-to-exclude-residential-farm-areas-from-western-ghats-esa-limits/3047969/>